PassReady Prep

THE COMPLETE

NCMHCE

STUDY GUIDE

Clinical Reasoning, Diagnostic Reference & Practice for the Case-Simulation Exam

NEW 2022+ EXAM FORMAT



103 diagnoses across 17 diagnostic families — differentials, discriminating features, first-line treatments

429 exam questions in 33 full-length case simulations, every answer keyed with rationales

6 rungs of the Priority Ladder — the decision framework the exam scores, from safety to relapse prevention

GA INTEGRATED THERAPEUTIC PERSPECTIVES LLC

The NCMHCE doesn't test what you know. It tests what you do next.

Every case on the exam gives you the diagnosis up front. What's scored is what you do with it — what you assess first, which rule-outs come before treatment, and how safety, alliance, and intervention are sequenced under the clock. This guide trains that sequence directly, then drills it until it holds.

- **The Priority Ladder** — a six-rung decision framework for what to do first, modeled in a fully worked intake-to-disposition case
- **Diagnostic reference** — 103 diagnoses across 17 families, with discriminating features, differentials, and first-line treatments
- **Three full-length exams** — 33 case simulations and 429 questions, every answer keyed with rationales and named clinical errors
- **Beyond the cases** — 153 supplemental questions, a psychopharmacology reference, and a ten-week Reasoning Skills Workbook

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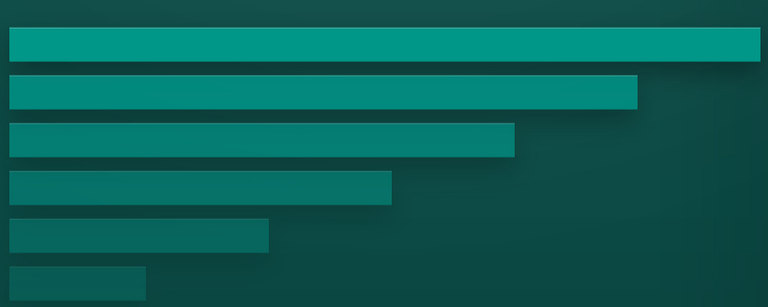
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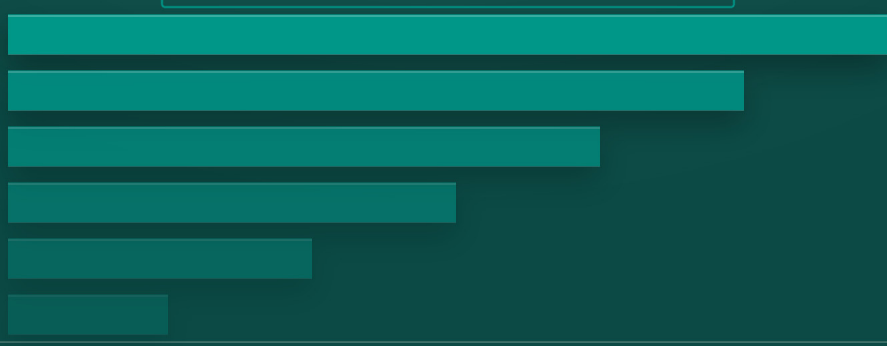
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STUDY GUIDE

Clinical Reasoning, Diagnostic Reference & Practice for the Case-Simulation Exam

The Next-Move Method: it's not only what you know. You also have to know the next move.

SECOND EDITION · 2027 EXAM



103 diagnoses across 17 diagnostic families — differentials, discriminating features, first-line treatments

390 exam questions in 30 full-length case simulations, built to the 2027 domain weights, every answer keyed with rationales

6 rungs of the Priority Ladder — the decision framework the exam scores, from safety to relapse prevention

GA INTEGRATED THERAPEUTIC PERSPECTIVES LLC

The NCMHCE doesn't test only what you know. It tests whether you know the next move.

Every case gives you a client, a clinical story, and four answers that all look reasonable. What's scored is what you do next — what you assess first, which rule-outs come before treatment, and how safety, alliance, and intervention are sequenced under the clock. This guide trains that sequence directly, then drills it until it holds.

- **The Next-Move Method** — one routine for every item, built on the six-rung Priority Ladder and a Clinical Reasoning Toolkit, modeled in a fully worked intake-to-disposition case
- **Diagnostic reference** — 103 diagnoses across 17 families, with discriminating features, differentials, and first-line treatments
- **Three full-length exams** — 30 case simulations and 390 questions built to the 2027 domain weights, plus 153 supplemental questions, every answer keyed with rationales
- **New for 2027** — Indirect Client Care with psychopharmacology, practice management and compliance, continuity of care, counselor self-awareness, and ICD-11 codes beside every diagnosis

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NCMHCE STUDY GUIDE

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STUDY GUIDE

Clinical Reasoning, Diagnostic Reference & Practice for the Case-Simulation Exam

The Next-Move Method: it's not only what you know. You also have to know the next move.

SECOND EDITION · 2027 EXAM



103	diagnoses across 17 diagnostic families — differentials, discriminating features, first-line treatments
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